

NORTHBRIDGE INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

Office of Academic Affairs

UNDERGRADUATE ATTENDANCE POLICY 2026

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Effective from: 1 August 2026

Classification: Academic policy - approved for student reference

1. Purpose

1.1 Regular participation in scheduled academic work is an essential part of every undergraduate course. This policy establishes the minimum attendance requirement, the method of calculation and the procedure to be followed when attendance is below the prescribed level.

1.2 The policy applies to lectures, tutorials, laboratories, studios, workshops, seminars and other scheduled course activities for undergraduate programmes offered by Northbridge Institute of Technology.

1.3 This policy should be read with the examination regulations and any formally issued attendance-relaxation notification. A later notification applies only to the extent expressly stated in that notification.

2. Minimum attendance requirement

2.1 A student must maintain at least 75 percent attendance in each registered course to be eligible to appear in the end-semester examination or final course assessment.

2.2 Attendance is assessed separately for every course. A high overall semester attendance percentage does not compensate for attendance below 75 percent in an individual course.

2.3 For a course without an end-semester examination, the same minimum applies to eligibility for the final practical, presentation, jury, viva or other concluding assessment.

2.4 A department may prescribe a higher attendance requirement for a clinical, field-based, safety-critical or professionally regulated course when the higher requirement is stated in the approved course outline before registration.

3. Calculation of attendance

3.1 Attendance percentage is calculated as the number of attended scheduled sessions divided by the number of sessions conducted, multiplied by 100.

3.2 A session cancelled by the Institute or rescheduled without adequate notice shall not be counted as a conducted session. A rescheduled session counts when it is announced through the official timetable or learning system.

3.3 Attendance records shall be maintained by the course instructor and updated at least once every seven calendar days. Students should review their records regularly and report possible errors promptly.

3.4 For combined lecture and laboratory courses, the department may calculate attendance separately for each component when the approved course outline states separate requirements.

4. Recording attendance

4.1 Attendance may be recorded through the Institute attendance system, a signed register or another method approved by the department. The instructor remains responsible for verifying the final record.

4.2 A student arriving more than fifteen minutes after the scheduled start may be marked absent unless the instructor accepts a documented academic or emergency reason.

4.3 Leaving a session before its completion without permission may be treated as absence. Attendance obtained through impersonation, proxy marking or manipulation of records constitutes misconduct.

5. Absence for approved activities

5.1 Participation in an Institute-approved academic, cultural or sports activity does not automatically count as attendance. The student must obtain activity approval and submit it to the department within three working days after returning.

5.2 The department may grant attendance credit for approved representation of the Institute when the student has completed any alternative work prescribed by the course instructor.

5.3 Travel days may be considered only when included in the approved activity schedule. Personal travel and preparation time are not eligible for attendance credit.

6. Medical and emergency absence

6.1 A medical certificate explains an absence but does not automatically convert the missed session into attendance. Medical circumstances are considered through the attendance-relaxation procedure.

6.2 Medical documents should be issued by a registered medical practitioner and should state the period during which the student was unable to attend academic activities.

6.3 A student should submit medical or emergency documents within five working days of returning to classes. Delayed submission may be accepted when the delay itself is supported by documented circumstances.

7. Attendance warnings

7.1 The attendance system shall provide an advisory warning when attendance in a course falls below 80 percent. The warning is intended to allow corrective action and does not change the minimum eligibility requirement.

7.2 A student receiving a warning should meet the course instructor or faculty adviser and review the number of remaining scheduled sessions.

7.3 Failure to receive an automated warning does not remove the student's responsibility to maintain the required attendance.

8. Shortage and examination eligibility

8.1 After the final instructional session, each department shall prepare the course-wise attendance list. A student with attendance of 75 percent or above shall be marked eligible, subject to other examination requirements.

8.2 A student below 75 percent shall be marked provisionally ineligible until any permitted relaxation application is decided.

8.3 A student with attendance below 65 percent in a course is not eligible for attendance relaxation under the ordinary medical or emergency procedure and must repeat the course when next offered, unless a separate exceptional order applies.

8.4 Attendance from 65 percent to 74 percent may be considered for relaxation only under the separate Undergraduate Attendance Relaxation Guidelines and does not create an automatic entitlement.

9. Correction of attendance records

9.1 A student who believes an attendance entry is incorrect must submit a correction request to the course instructor within five working days of the record being published.

9.2 The request must identify the course, date and session concerned. Supporting evidence may include a signed laboratory record, assessment submission or official activity approval.

9.3 If the matter is not resolved by the instructor, the student may refer it to the Head of Department within three further working days. The decision shall be based on the available institutional record.

10. Responsibilities

10.1 Students are responsible for attending scheduled sessions, checking published attendance and reporting discrepancies within the prescribed time.

10.2 Course instructors are responsible for maintaining accurate records, publishing updates regularly and responding to correction requests.

10.3 Departments are responsible for monitoring the publication of attendance, reviewing unresolved discrepancies and issuing the final eligibility list.

10.4 The Office of Academic Affairs is responsible for maintaining this policy, issuing clarification where required and coordinating any Institute-wide amendments.

11. Special course arrangements

11.1 For internships, projects and field courses where attendance cannot be recorded by ordinary class sessions, the department shall define participation requirements before registration.

11.2 Online or blended sessions count toward attendance when they are included in the official course schedule. The instructor may use authenticated participation records, required activities or another announced method to verify attendance.

11.3 Attendance requirements for make-up classes shall be the same as for regular sessions when the make-up schedule is announced at least twenty-four hours in advance, except in an emergency closure.

12. Misconduct and falsification

12.1 Creating a false attendance record, marking attendance for another student, altering an attendance document or submitting a fabricated medical certificate may be referred for disciplinary action.

12.2 Correction of a genuine administrative error is not misconduct. No adverse finding shall be made without giving the student an opportunity to respond.

12.3 Where a suspected falsification affects examination eligibility, the department may place the decision on hold until the preliminary verification is completed.

13. Appeals

13.1 An appeal against the final course attendance percentage must first be submitted to the Head of Department within three working days of publication of the eligibility list.

13.2 A further appeal may be submitted to the Dean of Academic Affairs within five working days of the departmental decision. The appeal must identify the disputed sessions and include all available supporting material.

13.3 An appeal based only on a request to waive the minimum percentage, without a permitted ground under the relaxation guidelines, shall not be considered as an attendance-record appeal.

14. Records and retention

14.1 Course attendance records and approved corrections shall be retained for at least one academic year after publication of the final result for the course.

14.2 Medical documents and relaxation decisions shall be handled as restricted student records and accessed only for the stated academic purpose.

15. Commencement and supersession

15.1 This policy takes effect on 1 August 2026 and supersedes the Undergraduate Attendance Policy 2025 for students and courses covered by this document.

15.2 The previous general minimum of 70 percent shall not apply to courses beginning on or after the effective date of this policy.

15.3 Any amendment must be issued through a numbered notification approved by the Institute Academic Council or another authority formally delegated for that purpose.